CLASSROOM FACILITATION · STANDWITHUS UK

Teacher guide: The Price of Peace

Audience: Sixth Form, ages 16 to 17
Duration: 5 to 8 minutes for the simulation, plus 5 minutes of discussion
Focus: Conflict resolution, leadership, negotiation and diplomatic compromise

Learning outcomes

By the end, students should be able to:

1. Explain why Israel and Egypt had different priorities after the 1967 and 1973 wars.
2. Identify the territorial, security and diplomatic concessions essential to the 1979 treaty.
3. Distinguish the 1978 Camp David frameworks from the 1979 treaty.
4. Explain why the Palestinian issue was part of the Camp David discussion but was not resolved by the bilateral treaty.
5. Evaluate the role of a third party mediator in overcoming diplomatic deadlock.

Historical background in 45 seconds

Israel captured the Sinai Peninsula from Egypt during the Six Day War in 1967. Egypt wanted to regain the territory. After the 1973 war, President Anwar Sadat pursued diplomacy, including his dramatic visit to Jerusalem in November 1977. Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin wanted lasting recognition and security, but removing Israeli settlements in Sinai was difficult politically. US President Jimmy Carter brought them together at Camp David in September 1978. The accords created frameworks for talks. The detailed peace treaty was signed on 26 March 1979.

Suggested classroom delivery

First minute: Split the class into two delegations. Print and distribute confidential role briefs from the game setup screen, or reveal the briefs privately on a device. Each team appoints a spokesperson. Ask students not to disclose their entire confidential document.

Minutes 2 to 7: Move through the five dossiers. Give roughly 45 to 60 seconds per issue. The teams discuss possible terms. Choose the joint proposal on screen. Each delegation publicly states whether it accepts or rejects. If a proposal fails, revise it or request Carter's assistance. Both delegations must accept a proposal to progress.

Final minute: Show the negotiated agreement alongside the historical outcomes. Students should identify compromises, red lines and remaining issues.

Follow up discussion: Ask which side made the most difficult concession, whether the 1979 treaty was possible without the 1978 frameworks, and why an agreement between two countries could not settle the wider conflict by itself.

Game mechanics

- Five dossiers, three proposals for each dossier.

- Israel, Egypt and mutual trust have fictional confidence scores from 0 to 100.
- Accepted proposals affect these scores, and rejected offers reduce trust by six points. These numbers help students visualise trade offs; they are not empirical measurements.
- Some proposals conflict with core national negotiating red lines. In Single Player, the computer refuses them. In Classroom Mode, teams can still record an agreement, but the final report flags such terms as fragile.
- Carter has two opportunities to suggest a compromise based on the main historical solution to that issue. This is a simplified representation of his real mediation, including his use of draft texts and separate discussions with leaders.
- Classroom Mode is intentionally local and shared device based. It does not secretly connect devices, record votes remotely or require accounts.
- The timer is a teaching aid and will not end a discussion automatically.

How to help students negotiate

Encourage pupils to distinguish **positions** from **interests**. A position is what a country publicly demands. An interest is the underlying need it is trying to protect. Egypt's need for sovereignty and Israel's need for security made a combination of withdrawal and restricted military deployment possible.

Remind students that accepting every demand made by one side is not the same as successful negotiation. Real agreements need to be politically feasible and implementable.

Teaching cautions

- The leaders' priorities are historically grounded but simplified. They are not private documents or quotations from the real negotiations.
- The individual proposals are reconstructed possibilities. Only the historical reveal describes the signed terms.
- The Camp David Accords of 1978 included a wider framework for the West Bank and Gaza. This did not resolve Palestinian sovereignty, borders or the final political status of those territories.
- The 1979 treaty restored Egyptian sovereignty over Sinai and established peace and diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt. Israeli withdrawal was completed in 1982, except that Taba was subject to a later border dispute.
- Egypt was suspended from the Arab League following the treaty and readmitted in 1989. This is included to demonstrate a cost to Sadat's foreign policy choices, not as a numeric game score.

Example prompt for discussion

> Our team wants full sovereignty, but the other government is concerned about defence. Can we design a practical agreement that meets both needs without asking either side to give up a fundamental interest?

Optional written task

Ask each team to write a 100 word diplomatic communiqué that explains one concession it made, why it accepted that concession and one issue that remains unresolved.

Meet the delegations

Select **Meet the teams** from the game header to introduce the leaders and advisers. Four figures are featured for each delegation. Begin, Sadat and Carter are central to the storyline; the other team members demonstrate that diplomacy depends on military, legal and foreign policy advisers as well as leaders. This archive contains public historical information, not the game’s private briefing. Students can open it without revealing the other team’s objectives.

The **Maps and photographs** tab shows an original illustrative Sinai diagram. The other image spaces will be populated with credited photographs and maps supplied by StandWithUs UK. The empty spaces are deliberate and do not affect gameplay.